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Lead Developer (Appian)

Office for Standards in Education, Children's Services and Skills

Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 14th June 2026

Reference number

464485

Salary

£68,635 - £72,791

£68,635 (National), £72,104 9(London) per annum. Rising to £69,322 (National), £72,791 (London) per annum on successful completion of probation.

We may offer a non contractual labour market supplement of up to £10,000 per annum, subject to your skills, experience and suitability for the post probation salary level.

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 7
Band A

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

OFSTED - Digital and Information

Type of role

Digital
Information Technology
Other

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

23 Stephenson Street, Birmingham

2 Rivergate, Bristol

10 South Colonnade, London

Piccadilly Gate, Manchester

Loxley House, Nottingham

About the job

Job summary

We are recruiting for a Lead Developer (Appian) to join our Digital Change team. You will act as the senior technical authority, setting engineering standards and ensuring secure, high-quality, and maintainable delivery.

In this role you will do:

- Lead technical direction and improve ways of working

- Apply deep Appian expertise and broad technical skills

- Recommend the right technologies and approaches

- Support and contribute to the wider developer community

- Mentor and coach developers across the team

- Drive best practice and promote knowledge sharing

A great opportunity for an experienced technical leader who wants to shape engineering culture and deliver impactful digital solutions.

This is a fantastic opportunity to further your experience in Ofsted's well-established team. The post holder will work with high-achieving professionals at all levels, surrounded by a friendly and supportive team. They will have access to amazing benefits, such as flexible working hours, the Civil Service Pension Scheme, and 32.5 days annual leave + 8 bank holidays. We offer a hybrid working model, so you may also choose to spend a proportion of time working from home.

Job description

Please refer to the job specification for further information.

Person specification

Please refer to the job specification for further information.

Qualifications

Current/active Appian Certified Lead Developer (Essential)

Working knowledge of a range of Microsoft Azure cloud services (Desirable)

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Delivering at Pace

Changing and Improving

Making Effective Decisions

Developing Self and Others

Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

Experience of leading the successful design, development and deployment of at least one Appian-based project in a large, complex, high-profile organisation. (Essential)

Experience of managing, leading or coaching team members to improve their knowledge and build effective capability.

Experience of working with the Scrum methodology, with a strong understanding of Agile principles. (Essential)

Effective at communicating verbally and in writing. Adept at tailoring message to explain technical matters clearly for non-technical audiences. (Essential)

Experience of the integration of Appian Cloud with non-Appian services. (Desirable)

We only ask for evidence of these technical skills on your application form:

Experience of leading the successful design, development and deployment of at least one Appian-based project in a large, complex, high-profile organisation. (Essential)

Experience of managing, leading or coaching team members to improve their knowledge and build effective capability.

Experience of working with the Scrum methodology, with a strong understanding of Agile principles. (Essential)

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £68,635, Office for Standards in Education, Children's Services and Skills contributes £19,883 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides.](#)

Full details of the benefits available can be found in our [Ofsted Offer](#) brochure .

Ofsted is devoted to equality, diversity and inclusion. Within our [Ofsted Strategy 2023-2027](#) we have stated that we will improve the representation of under-represented groups across the organisation and publish our progress on this annually. We are always looking to expand on our diverse workforce by recruiting candidates from varied backgrounds and differing experiences. We are proud to be a Disability Confident Leader, we continually engage with our 5 staff networks for protected characteristics, and highlight the work of our Equalities, Diversity and Inclusion (EDI) Group.

We ensure all candidates are treated with fair and open competition, with all appointments being made on merit and we use our Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) to provide assurance to all candidates of this.

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Behaviours, Experience and Technical skills.

Application and shortlisting

The selection panel will assess your application/personal statement explaining how you meet the essential and, where applicable, desirable criteria outlined in the job description and person specification.

You will also be asked to provide information within the Employer/Activity History section of the application form. This information is equivalent to the information you would provide on a CV setting out your career history (this may be used in the sifting process).

If we receive a high number of applications, an initial sift will be conducted based on the following lead criterion:

Experience of leading the successful design, development, and deployment of at least one Appian-based project in a large, complex, high-profile organisation.

Applicants who meet this initial eligibility criterion will be invited to progress to the next stage of the selection process. If required, a further full sift will be undertaken, where all applications that passed the initial sift will be assessed against the complete set of essential criteria outlined in the job description.

Assessment and Interview

Candidates who pass the benchmark at the shortlisting stage will be invited to an assessment and interview where you will be assessed against a combination of the the Civil Service behaviours and the technical/experience skills set out in section 3 of the job specification.

Assessment and interviews will be held during the **week commencing 29 June 2026** at **23 Stephenson Street, Birmingham.**

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals

- nationals of the Republic of Ireland

- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application

for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : People Services Delivery Team

Email : jobs@ofsted.gov.uk

Telephone : 03000 131 487

Recruitment team

Email : jobs@ofsted.gov.uk

Further information

The law requires that selection for appointment to the Civil Service is on merit on the basis of fair and open competition as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's Recruitment Principles, which can be found at:

https://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/wp-content/uploads/2019/03/02a_RECRUITMENT-PRINCIPLES-April-2018-FINAL-.pdf

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles, and you wish to make a complaint, you should email Ofsted recruitment at jobs@ofsted.gov.uk in the first instance.

If you are not satisfied with the response you receive from the Department, you can contact the Civil Service Commission at:

<https://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/recruitment/civilservicerecruitmentcomplaints/>



